

Sustainability Report — University College Cork

Prepared **with reference to** the GRI Standards · compiled 2026-08-30

About this report. It is generated from University College Cork's public AASHE STARS 3.0 submission, mapped onto the GRI Standards. It covers 78 GRI disclosures across 13 standards. Where a disclosure cannot be answered from STARS data, the report says so and why, rather than omitting the question. **How the figures got here — and why they can be trusted.** Every number in this document was copied by code from the extracted STARS dataset. The language model that wrote the prose was never shown a figure: it wrote named placeholders and the values were substituted afterwards, so it could not alter, round or invent one. After substitution the finished text is scanned, and the build fails if any number in it cannot be traced back to the source data. The model chose the sentences; it did not choose the numbers. **What that guarantee does not cover.** It applies to figures. Qualitative statements are drawn from the institution's own STARS narrative answers, but no mechanical check confirms that a sentence describing them is faithful. **"With reference to", not "in accordance with".** GRI reserves **"in accordance"** for reports answering every Universal Disclosure plus all disclosures for each material topic. This report does not, so it makes the weaker and correct claim. **Source and attribution.** [University College Cork STARS Report](<https://reports.aashe.org/institutions/university-college-cork-national-university-of-ireland-cork-co-corcaigh/report/2026-03-05/>), AASHE. STARS data is publicly accessible and used here with attribution to AASHE; it is not openly licensed.

The organisation and its reporting

Institutional Details and Operational Boundary

University College Cork is a public higher education institution. Its operational scope includes a medical school, a museum, and satellite campuses.

The institutional boundary applied to this sustainability report covers the main campus and satellite campuses managed directly by the University's Buildings and Estates office. Subsidiary entities fall outside this boundary; specifically, Campus Accommodation, the Mardyke Arena, the Student Centre, and the Irish Management Institute in Dublin are excluded from the reporting scope. In accordance with reporting guidelines, rented multi-tenant buildings are also excluded.

Reporting Process and External Assurance

The compilation of this report was led by the Head of Sustainability and Climate, Dr Maria Kirrane. The evaluation of environmental impacts covers Scope 1 and Scope 2 GHG emissions, for which the performance year is 2024.

External assurance was obtained for specific environmental datasets. The institution's Scope 1 and Scope 2 greenhouse gas emissions figures were independently audited and verified by Sustineo, the University's contracted carbon footprint provider.

Reporting Limitations and Data Gaps

This report relies on data structured around specific sustainability assessment tools, which presents certain limitations when mapped against the GRI Standards:

- Under Disclosure 2-1, institutional details such as the official legal name, headquarters location, and explicit countries of operation are not captured in the reporting framework.
- For Disclosure 2-2, the underlying framework does not collect information regarding whether the reporting boundary differs from the entities included in the institution's financial statements, nor how minority interests are consolidated.
- Regarding Disclosure 2-3, named process leads are recorded without formal contact details. Additionally, the data framework lacks a single baseline reporting period, publication date, or stated reporting frequency, as individual credit timelines vary.
- In line with Disclosure 2-4, restatements of information from previous reporting cycles are not reported, as submissions are compiled as independent snapshots without restatement mechanisms.
- For Disclosure 2-5, while external verification of Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions by Sustineo is confirmed, the specific assurance standards applied, the exact level of assurance obtained, process limitations, and detailed provider relationships are not recorded.
- Under Disclosure 2-6, the physical campus features listed cover institutional activities with a physical footprint, but details regarding full value chains, broader commercial sectors, products, services, and target markets are omitted.

Activities and workers

Workforce Size and Structure

University College Cork carries out its higher education, research, and administrative functions through a dedicated workforce. The institution reports an overall staff baseline of 3,643 full-time equivalent employees. Academic and professional personnel contribute across core institutional activities, including teaching, research, recruitment, student engagement, and public service.

Reporting Framework Gaps and Limitations

While the reported figure provides an overview of operational capacity, current data collection systems present limitations when evaluated against GRI standards.

In relation to GRI 2-7, the institution relies on full-time equivalent metrics rather than direct headcount figures. Disclosure 2-7 requires a comprehensive breakdown of

employees by employment contract (permanent and temporary), employment type (full-time and part-time), gender, and region. A single full-time equivalent figure does not reflect individual personnel headcounts—where two half-time staff members are calculated as one full-time equivalent—nor does it provide the necessary demographic or contractual disaggregations.

Furthermore, data required under GRI 2-8 regarding workers who are not employees is not reported. The institution's tracking systems record direct employees and enrolled students, but do not capture the total headcount or contractual arrangements of non-employee workers operating under institutional control, such as third-party agency staff or individual contractors.

Material topics

The sustainability topics covered in this report are aligned with the framework established by the Sustainability Tracking, Assessment & Rating System (STARS), developed by the Association for the Advancement of Sustainability in Higher Education for the higher-education sector. University College Cork did not run an independent materiality assessment to identify or prioritize institution-specific topics. Consequently, the topics reported reflect the standardized STARS structure rather than a bespoke materiality determination.

Operational and Institutional Objectives

Under GRI 3-2, the reporting scope encompasses standard sector areas where University College Cork has adopted measurable sustainability objectives: * Campus operations * Teaching, learning, and research * Equity and social justice * Administration and finance * Campus and community engagement

Within campus operations, the University maintains measurable targets set out in its Sustainability and Climate Action Plan. These include commitments to exceed national reduction targets for Scope 1 and Scope 2 greenhouse gas emissions, as well as achieving net zero total greenhouse gas emissions. Operational objectives also cover adapting estate management policies and infrastructure for climate resilience, securing funding for carbon reduction programmes, applying a Living Laboratory model to campus sustainability solutions, and preserving green spaces in accordance with the campus masterplan.

Governance and Management

Institutional management under GRI 3-3 is led by the Head of Sustainability and Climate Action within the Office of Sustainability and Climate Action. This office oversees governance bodies including the Green Campus Committee, the Green Forum, and a University Leadership Team subcommittee focused on sustainability and climate action.

Key outcomes coordinated through this structure include the publication of the institutional Sustainability and Climate Action Plan, securing external Green Flag

accreditation, maintaining international university sustainability rankings, and managing the Green Campus Living Laboratory Fund. The institution maintains public commitments to sustainability through published strategic plans and external charter participation.

Data Limitations and Omissions

- **GRI 3-1 Process to determine material topics:** Not reported. The University does not carry out a dedicated materiality assessment. Process details regarding how actual and potential impacts on the economy, environment, and people were identified, prioritised, or informed by stakeholder engagement are therefore unavailable.
- **GRI 3-2 List of material topics:** The reported topic areas represent fixed STARS credit categories rather than an institution-specific impact evaluation, and historical comparisons against previous reporting periods are not captured by this dataset.
- **GRI 3-3 Management of material topics:** Management mechanisms are reported institution-wide rather than on a topic-by-topic basis. The source framework does not record specific positive or negative impacts, does not differentiate direct operational involvement from business relationships, does not separate harm prevention from remediation, and does not report lessons learned.

Governance

Governance Structure and Composition

The highest decision-making body of University College Cork is the Governing Authority. Decision-making representation on the Governing Authority encompasses key internal campus constituencies, including academic staff, non-managerial staff, and student representatives. Academic staff representation on the Governing Authority is determined through democratic election by university staff.

Delegation of Responsibility

Responsibility for coordinating sustainability across campus constituencies is delegated to specific administrative officers. Dedicated roles within the university include the Head of Sustainability and Climate Action, the Sustainability Support Officer, and the Greenshoots coordinator, who focuses specifically on student engagement. These officers lead and coordinate sustainability initiatives across operational and academic units.

Role in Sustainability Reporting

In relation to GRI 2-14, executive endorsement of the institution's sustainability reporting submission is evidenced by formal cover documentation submitted alongside institutional assessment data.

Limitations and Unreported Disclosures

The available source material presents several reporting limitations. Regarding governance composition under GRI 2-9, the data confirms constituency representation but does not supply full numerical details on overall board size, executive status, independence, tenure, or demographic background. For GRI 2-13, designated officers carry operational responsibility, but formal reporting lines and the frequency of updates to the Governing Authority are not specified. Under GRI 2-14, executive cover documentation indicates executive endorsement rather than formal review and approval of material topics by the highest governance body.

Where GRI framework indicators request information on governing body behaviour and oversight processes, the source material contains no records. Specifically, the data does not address: - Nomination and selection mechanisms for governing body members under Disclosure 2-10 - Leadership structure and conflict management regarding the chair under Disclosure 2-11 - Direct oversight of impact due diligence and stakeholder engagement under Disclosure 2-12 - Processes for preventing and disclosing conflicts of interest under Disclosure 2-15 - Communication channels and volume of critical concerns under Disclosure 2-16 - Measures to advance the collective sustainability knowledge of board members under Disclosure 2-17 - Performance evaluation of the highest governance body under Disclosure 2-18 - Remuneration policies and determination processes under Disclosure 2-19 and Disclosure 2-20 - The annual compensation ratio under Disclosure 2-21, which is left uncalculated in the reported data.

Strategy, policies and practices

Sustainability Vision and Commitments

University College Cork (UCC) details its strategic direction through its Sustainability and Climate Action Plan, which builds upon its prior sustainability strategy. The university aims to embed sustainability principles across education, research, campus infrastructure, administration, and community engagement. Key institutional goals focus on campus waste elimination and reaching carbon neutrality.

In addition to internal strategies, UCC is subject to statutory requirements from the Irish government to reduce its absolute greenhouse gas emissions. The university publishes annual climate action roadmaps outlining the measures planned to meet these statutory targets.

Governance and Embedding Policy Commitments

Coordination of sustainability efforts is directed by the Head of Sustainability and Climate Action through the Office of Sustainability and Climate Action. This office oversees key institutional bodies, including the Green Campus Committee, the Green Forum, and the University Leadership Team Subcommittee on Sustainability and Climate Action. Operational achievements include administering the Green Campus Living

Laboratory Fund, securing Green Flag accreditation from the Foundation for Environmental Education, and participating in global sustainability rankings.

To integrate sustainability into university operations, UCC enforces a code of conduct for suppliers that outlines social and environmental expectations. In addition, regular sustainability-focused training opportunities are made available to non-academic staff.

Grievances and Mechanisms for Raising Concerns

UCC maintains published policies outlining employee rights, grievance resolution, and mechanisms for raising concerns. Accessible documentation covers grievance procedures, whistleblower protections, and frameworks to address sexual violence and harassment. Operational policies recognize fundamental constitutional rights, including freedom of association, and facilitate union representation through partners such as the Irish Federation of University Teachers.

Summary of Governance Disclosures and Limitations

Certain GRI disclosures cannot be fully reported due to the structure of available data: - **Strategy and Commitments (Disclosure 2-22, GRI 2-23, GRI 2-28):** Under Disclosure 2-22, the published strategic vision is recorded without attribution to a named executive signatory. For GRI 2-23 and GRI 2-28, reported commitments center on broad sustainability and statutory emissions targets rather than explicit human rights due diligence or UN Guiding Principles, and organizational association memberships are not captured. - **Embedding Commitments (Disclosure 2-24):** Available information highlights institutional achievements and general non-academic training rather than formal internal allocations of responsibility, integration into business relationships, or training on specific policy commitments. - **Grievance and Whistleblower Mechanisms (Disclosure 2-25, Disclosure 2-26):** Records confirm the publication of policies for employees, but do not detail operational workflows, mechanism effectiveness, or coverage for external stakeholders and business relationships. - **Compliance with Laws and Regulations (GRI 2-27):** Information regarding non-compliance with laws, regulations, or associated fines is not collected within the underlying dataset, leaving GRI 2-27 unreported.

Stakeholder engagement

Consultation Mechanisms for Students and Staff

University College Cork consults with internal stakeholders through established deliberative bodies and governance forums. Student participation in strategic decisions, policy formulation, and institutional planning is facilitated primarily through the UCC Student Forum. Modeled on the structure of the Irish Citizens' Assembly, this forum serves as a platform for deliberative democracy, embedding student input into university decision-making to enhance institutional transparency and integrity.

Academic staff are consulted via the Academic Leadership Forum, a non-executive body that acts as a strategic reference group for academic leadership. This forum facilitates institutional dialogue on key operational and strategic matters, including admissions quotas, postgraduate entry, and cross-university initiatives, prior to formal submission to the Academic Council or Academic Board. Additionally, the forum coordinates university inputs for national higher education calls, promotes interdisciplinary initiatives, and supports integration between teaching and research activities across faculties.

Local Community Engagement

The university maintains engagement mechanisms for local community members and neighbourhood organisations. Consultation occurs through both targeted ad hoc interactions and standing channels, including direct engagement with community bodies such as the Magazine Road Residents Association. University College Cork maintains ongoing structures through which non-affiliated community-based organisations can participate democratically in institutional governance processes. External community stakeholder engagement is further embedded in academic practices through engaged research frameworks, which require societal partners, service users, and public representatives to be consulted during the design and execution of research projects.

Framework Limitations and Omissions

While the institution maintains structures for consulting core campus groups, reporting under Disclosure GRI 2-29 is subject to scope limitations imposed by the underlying data collection framework. The framework focuses on predefined campus constituencies and does not record details regarding how stakeholders are systematically identified, how the effectiveness of engagement is evaluated, or how specific external groups—such as suppliers, customers, or vulnerable populations—are consulted.

Regarding Disclosure GRI 2-30, the university does not report the percentage of its total employee workforce covered by collective bargaining agreements. The available reporting standards track institutional policies on freedom of association and contractor wage thresholds, but do not collect total collective bargaining coverage data across all staff categories.

Environmental performance

Energy Consumption and Intensity

Total annual energy consumption within University College Cork stands at 55,148.70 Megawatt-hours Megawatt-hours under Disclosure 302-1. Electricity consumption accounts for 32,599.70 Megawatt-hours Megawatt-hours, stationary fuel consumption contributes 22,549 Megawatt-hours Megawatt-hours, and off-site heating and cooling sources supply 0 Megawatt-hours Megawatt-hours.

The stationary fuel mix comprises natural gas at 22,549 Megawatt-hours Megawatt-hours, heating oil at 0 Megawatt-hours Megawatt-hours, coal and coke at 0 Megawatt-hours Megawatt-hours, and propane or LPG at 0 Megawatt-hours Megawatt-hours. Total annual renewable energy consumption reaches 0.70 Megawatt-hours Megawatt-hours, of which renewable stationary fuels supply 0 Megawatt-hours Megawatt-hours. On-site renewable electricity exported back to the grid totals 0 Megawatt-hours Megawatt-hours.

Energy intensity evaluated under Disclosure 302-3 is 2,139.20 Kilowatt-hours Kilowatt-hours per person, calculated using a denominator of full-time equivalent student and employee headcount. Expressed by building area, energy intensity is 195.31 Kilowatt-hours per square meter Kilowatt-hours per square metre, using gross campus floor area as the denominator. Standard reporting under GRI 302-1 requires energy data in joules or multiples thereof, necessitating conversion from Megawatt-hours.

Greenhouse Gas Emissions

Direct Scope 1 GHG emissions under Disclosure 305-1 total 6,215.78 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. This includes 5,517 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons from stationary combustion, 62.78 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons from mobile combustion, and 636 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons of fugitive emissions. Biogenic greenhouse gas emissions account for 0 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. Scope 1 process emissions were unmapped for the reporting period.

Energy indirect Scope 2 GHG emissions under Disclosure 305-2 equal 8,144 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. Location-based emissions from off-site electricity sources stand at 8,144 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons, while market-based emissions from off-site electricity equal 8,144 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons. Off-site heating and cooling energy sources contribute 0 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons of CO₂ equivalent.

Other indirect Scope 3 GHG emissions reported under Disclosure 305-3 cover business travel at 3,565 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons, employee and student commuting at 20,991 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons, purchased goods and services at 1,572 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons, capital goods at 0 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons, and fuel- and energy-related activities not included in Scope 1 or Scope 2 at 3,318 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons. Scope 3 emissions arising from operational waste generation were unmapped.

Under Disclosure 305-4, combined Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions intensity is 557.01 Kilograms of CO₂ equivalent kilograms of CO₂ equivalent per person (denominated by full-time equivalent student and staff headcount) and 50.86 Kilograms per square meter kilograms per square metre of gross campus floor area.

In accordance with Ireland's public sector climate mandates, the baseline year for Scope 1 and Scope 2 GHG emissions is set to 2017, with baseline emissions recorded at 19,460 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. UCC has achieved a 26.21

percentage reduction in combined Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions relative to this baseline under Disclosure 305-5. Carbon footprint accounting was compiled by Sustineo using top-down spend analysis and bottom-up operational data in accordance with the GHG Protocol standard, with figures submitted annually to the Sustainable Energy Authority of Ireland.

Water Withdrawal and Management

Total water withdrawal under Disclosure 303-3 is 54,153 Cubic meters cubic metres. Potable water supplied from third-party off-site municipal utilities accounts for 54,153 Cubic meters cubic metres, whereas potable water drawn from on-site sources is 0 Cubic meters cubic metres. Reporting under Disclosure 303-3 requires converting cubic metres to megalitres by dividing by one thousand.

The physical water quantity risk for the main university campus is rated as low-medium. UCC mitigates freshwater reliance through on-site rainwater harvesting systems utilized for non-potable storage and campus operations.

Waste Generation and Diversion

Under Disclosure 306-3, annual non-hazardous waste generation amounts to 520 Metric tons metric tons, while construction and demolition activity generates 6,914.08 Metric tons metric tons of waste.

Waste diversion performance under Disclosure 306-4 includes 242 Metric tons metric tons of non-hazardous waste. Recovery paths comprise 183 Metric tons metric tons recycled, 59 Metric tons metric tons composted (supported by accepting compostable lunchboxes in campus organic waste streams), and 0 Metric tons metric tons prepared for reuse. Diversion of construction and demolition waste totals 6,837.95 Metric tons metric tons, of which 5,675.22 Metric tons metric tons is recycled.

Waste directed to disposal under Disclosure 306-5 includes 278 Metric tons metric tons of non-hazardous waste and 76.13 Metric tons metric tons of construction and demolition waste sent to landfill or incineration. Institutional waste management practices include an asset surplus program for campus property, a reuse program for personal items, single-use plastic elimination measures, and standard hazardous waste management protocols.

Sustainable Procurement

Under Disclosure 308-1, 21 percentage of formal bid solicitations incorporate supplier sustainability requirements. While environmental criteria are integrated into tender documentation, UCC's institutional supplier code of conduct does not currently establish mandatory environmental performance targets beyond compliance with existing regulatory standards.

Reporting Limitations and Omissions

The following limitations apply to the data available for this report: - GRI 301-1, GRI 301-2, and GRI 301-3: Not reported; UCC produces no physical goods or commercial packaging. - GRI 302-2 and GRI 302-5: Upstream and downstream value-chain energy consumption and product-related energy reductions are not tracked. - GRI 302-4: Energy reductions are evaluated via GHG emissions metrics rather than direct thermal and electrical energy units against a base year. - GRI 303-1 and GRI 303-2: Water risk assessments are limited to the main campus; effluent discharge standards and operational processes causing water impacts are not monitored. GRI 303-3 does not separate water withdrawals by water-stressed regions. - GRI 305-1, GRI 305-2, and GRI 305-5: Historical baseline figures combine Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions into a single aggregate total. Absolute tonnage reductions by specific gas or individual scope are not disaggregated. - GRI 305-6 and GRI 305-7: Air emissions of ozone-depleting substances, NO_x, SO_x, and other localized air pollutants are not measured. - GRI 306-1, GRI 306-3, GRI 306-4, and GRI 306-5: Tonnage data excludes hazardous waste. Waste disposal metrics combine landfilling and incineration into a single total without distinguishing waste-to-energy recovery. - GRI 308-1 and GRI 308-2: Procurement metrics measure initial bid solicitation specifications rather than the percentage of new suppliers screened post-award, and supplier environmental impact assessments are not formally tracked.

Social and economic performance

Compensation and Wage Standards

University College Cork tracks entry-level pay against local economic indicators. The institutional wage floor for regular permanent employees is 16.40, compared against a local living wage benchmark of 15.40. The proportion of university employees receiving remuneration equal to or exceeding this living wage threshold is 100. These figures are expressed in Euros as part of the higher education sector reporting framework.

Working Conditions and Leave Entitlements

Employment conditions incorporate parental leave provisions and broad leave eligibility. Across all employee groups, the percentage of staff eligible for paid all-gender family or medical leave is 100. Under institutional maternity leave policies and relevant legislation, entitled staff receive 26 weeks of fully paid maternity leave, with provisions for additional unpaid leave periods. The university also maintains support mechanisms for personnel returning from long-term leave.

Occupational Health, Safety, and Wellbeing

Worker representation and health management are structured around consultation mechanisms and preventive care. The university maintains an institution-wide Safety Representative Forum, which brings together staff representatives and management. Safety representatives assist with workplace health and welfare by conducting safety

tours, participating in Safety Action Teams, and reviewing dangerous occurrence and accident reports.

The institution provides physical health services, behavioural health services, reduced-cost fitness opportunities, and spiritual or contemplative activities for staff. Smoking is restricted, although a total prohibition is not in place across the entirety of the campus grounds.

Workforce Diversity and Governance

Workforce composition is tracked across governance, academic, and non-academic categories. The proportion of executive staff identifying as women or other marginalised gender identities is 47. Among regular permanent academic staff, 49 identify as women or other marginalised gender identities, while for regular permanent non-academic staff, the figure is 63.

Ethnic diversity is monitored using a concentration index rather than percentage distributions. The ethnic diversity index is 0 for executive staff, 0.44 for academic staff, and 0.34 for non-academic staff.

Limitations and Unreported Data

Data collected under sector-specific standards present several variances from standard disclosures: - **GRI 202-1:** The university reports entry wage floors relative to a living wage benchmark rather than statutory minimum wage rates. The standard ratio breakdown by gender is not collected, and separate wage floors for casual staff are omitted. - **GRI 401-2 & GRI 401-3:** Benefit eligibility is supplied as an aggregate rate without full-time versus temporary or part-time comparisons. Maternity leave policy durations are stated, but headcount metrics regarding uptake, return-to-work, and retention rates by gender are not compiled. - **GRI 403-1, GRI 403-3, GRI 403-4, & GRI 403-6:** Occupational health data demonstrate committee existence and wellbeing programmes, but lack information on management system standards, audit boundaries, meeting frequencies, decision-making authority, or hazard identification procedures. - **GRI 405-1:** Gender diversity metrics combine female and marginalised gender identities into a single percentage rather than distinct buckets, age group distributions are uncollected, and governance body composition percentages are not provided.

The university does not currently report on GRI 202-2 (senior management hired from the local community), GRI 204-1 (spending on local suppliers), GRI 401-1 (new hires and turnover), GRI 403-2 (hazard assessment and incident investigation), GRI 403-5 (OHS training), GRI 403-7 (OHS impacts in business relationships), GRI 403-8 (OHS management system coverage counts), GRI 403-9 (work-related injuries), GRI 403-10 (work-related ill health), or GRI 405-2 (gender remuneration ratios).

GRI content index

Reported	Partially reported	Not reported	Not assessed
25	15	38	0

“With reference to”, not “in accordance with.” GRI reserves in accordance for reports answering every Universal Disclosure (GRI 2) plus all disclosures for each material topic. This report does not, so it uses the weaker and correct claim.

GRI 2: General Disclosures 2021

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-1 Organizational details	Reported	Institutional control: Public	GRI 2-1 also requires the legal name, the location of headquarters and the countries of operation. STARS carries none of these as fields — they are report metadata, not credit data.
2-2 Entities included in the organization’s sustainability reporting	Reported	Narrative outlining the institutional boundary used to complete this report: This submission covers all of UCC main campus and satellite campuses that are under the...	GRI 2-2-b/c additionally ask whether the reporting entities differ from those in the financial statements and how minority interests are consolidated. STARS asks neither.
2-3 Reporting period, frequency and contact point	Partially reported	Performance year for scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 2024 List of personnel who led the reporting process: Dr Maria Kirrane, Head of Sustainability and Climate	STARS has no single reporting period, and the per-credit years diverge inside one submission: Cork’s credits run from 2023 (construction waste) to 2025 (living wage, investment), Berkeley’s from 2023 to 2024. Only TU Dublin is uniform, at 2023. Any single period stated for a GRI report built on this data would be wrong for some of its figures. GRI 2-3 also requires the reporting frequency, the publication date and a contact point; STARS collects none of these. Named preparers are not a designated contact point: STARS records names and roles without contact details, and does not say who should receive enquiries.
2-4 Restatements of information	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS v2.2 and earlier scored Operations credits against the institution’s own baseline and v3.0 scores against a peer group, so cross-version figures are not comparable in the first place — see CLAUDE.md 6.4.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-5 External assurance	Reported	Were any independent audits or external assurance processes used in the preparation of this report?: Yes Narrative outlining the independent audits or external assurance processes used in the preparation of this report: Emissions figures were verified by the University's contracted carbon footprint provide...	GRI 2-5 additionally requires the assurance standard used, the level of assurance obtained, the limitations of the process and the relationship with the assurance provider. STARS captures none of these; the free-text field is optional and unstructured. Only populated where the institution answered yes to the assurance question, so it is absent for most submissions.
2-6 Activities, value chain and other business relationships	Partially reported	Which of the following features are included within the institutional boundary?: Medical school Museum Satellite campus(es)	GRI 2-6 asks for the sectors the organization is active in, its value chain, its products and services and the markets served. A list of campus features covers only the activities, and only those with a physical footprint.
2-7 Employees	Partially reported	Full-time equivalent of employees: 3,643	FTE is not a headcount: two half-time staff count as one. GRI 2-7 further requires the breakdown by employment contract (permanent / temporary), by employment type (full- / part-time), by gender and by region. STARS collects a single undifferentiated figure.
2-8 Workers who are not employees	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-9 Governance structure and composition	Reported	Are one or more academic staff representatives included as members of the institution's highest decision-making body?: Yes Are one or more staff members representing non-managerial workers included as members of the institution's highest decision-making body?: Yes Are one or more student representatives included as members of the institution's highest decision-making body?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL outlining academic staff representation on the institution's highest decision-making body: Two spaces on the UCC Governing Authority democratically elected by staff of UCC. https://www.ucc.ie/en/about/who-we-are/governance/	GRI 2-9 also requires the number of executive and non-executive members, their independence, tenure, other significant positions held, and composition by gender and under-represented social group. STARS records only whether each constituency is represented. See the caveat on the academic-staff row: representation is recorded, composition is not. See the caveat on the academic-staff row. Free text of variable depth; it is not a substitute for the numeric composition GRI 2-9-c requires.
2-10 Nomination and selection of the highest governance body	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-11 Chair of the highest governance body	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-12 Role of the highest governance body in overseeing the management of impacts	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-13 Delegation of responsibility for managing impacts	Reported	Does the institution have one or more sustainability officers?: Yes Is at least one of the institution's sustainability committees, officers, or offices charged with coordinating various campus constituencies in the advancement of sustainability across the entire institution?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's sustainability officers: Dr Maria Kirrane is the University's Head of Sustainability and Climate Action, while S...	GRI 2-13-b also requires whether and how often those executives report to the highest governance body. STARS does not ask. See the caveat on the sustainability-officer row. Free text; the reporting line to the highest governance body is not consistently stated.
2-14 Role of the highest governance body in sustainability reporting	Partially reported	Executive cover letter: 03.03.26-STARSProgrammeSubmission.pdf	Endorsement by a senior executive is not review and approval by the highest governance body, and STARS records neither who approved the content nor whether material topics were reviewed. The field value is an attachment filename, so the letter's text is not in the dataset.
2-15 Conflicts of interest	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-16 Communication of critical concerns	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-17 Collective knowledge of the highest governance body	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-18 Evaluation of the performance of the highest governance body	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-19 Remuneration policies	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-20 Process to determine remuneration	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-21 Annual total compensation ratio	Not reported	Mapped to STARS, but this institution left every mapped field blank.	The denominator differs and the difference is large. GRI 2-21 divides the highest-paid individual by the MEDIAN of all other employees; STARS divides the highest-paid senior administrator by the LOWEST-paid full-time employee. The STARS figure is therefore a top-to-bottom spread, not a top-to-typical ratio, and is not comparable with any GRI 2-21 figure published elsewhere. IL-62 is also an Innovation & Leadership bonus credit, so it is optional: only TU Dublin reports it (8.08); Berkeley and Cork leave it blank.
2-22 Statement on sustainable development strategy	Partially reported	Narrative detailing the institution's guiding vision or goals for sustainability and the plan(s) in which they are published: The Sustainability and Climate Action Plan (2023-2028) builds on the successes of UCC's...	GRI 2-22 requires the statement to come from the highest governance body or the most senior executive. STARS records the institution's published vision without attributing it to a named signatory, so the authorship the disclosure turns on is absent.
2-23 Policy commitments	Reported	Has the institution made a public commitment to sustainability, as evidenced by an external commitment or a published plan?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL outlining the institution's external sustainability commitments that include a reporting requirement: UCC is required by the Irish government to reduce our absolute GHG emissions by 51% by ...	GRI 2-23 specifically requires commitments to respect human rights, to the UN Guiding Principles and to due diligence. A sustainability commitment is broader and does not imply any of these. STARS asks only for commitments carrying a reporting requirement, so commitments without one are out of scope of the field.
2-24 Embedding policy commitments	Reported	Does the institution have a published code of conduct to guide suppliers on the institution's social and environmental expectations for them?: Yes Does the institution make available sustainability-focused training opportunities to non-academic staff on at least an annual basis?: Yes Narrative outlining the activities and substantive accomplishments of the institution-wide coordinating body or officer during the previous three years: The Head of Sustainability and Climate Action coordinates the Office of Sustainability ...	GRI 2-24 also requires how responsibility is allocated internally and how the commitments are embedded in strategies and procedures. STARS asks about non-academic staff only, and about sustainability training generally rather than training on the specific commitments. It describes outcomes, not the allocation of responsibility, the integration into procedures, or the handling of commitments through business relationships that GRI 2-24-a enumerates.
2-25 Processes to remediate negative impacts	Partially reported	Does the institution publish information on grievance resolution in a format that is accessible to all employees?: Yes	STARS records only that the information is published — not how the mechanism operates, who may use it, or its effectiveness — and covers employees only, where GRI 2-25 covers all affected stakeholders.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-26 Mechanisms for seeking advice and raising concerns	Reported	Does the institution publish information on whistleblower protections in a format that is accessible to all employees?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's published measures to protect employee rights: https://www.ucc.ie/en/edi/sexual-violence-harassment-framework/ https://www.ucc.ie/en/h...	STARS records publication, not a description of how the mechanism operates, and covers employees only. GRI 2-26 extends to all individuals, including those in business relationships. Employees only; see the caveat on the whistleblower row.
2-27 Compliance with laws and regulations	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-28 Membership associations	Partially reported	Narrative and/or website URL outlining the institution's external sustainability commitments that include a reporting requirement: UCC is required by the Irish government to reduce our absolute GHG emissions by 51% by ...	Signing a charter is not membership of an association, and STARS restricts the field to commitments carrying a reporting requirement. The institution's association memberships are not collected as such.
2-29 Approach to stakeholder engagement	Reported	Description of other mechanisms used to consult students on institutional decisions, plans, or policies: Born from UCC's strategic plan, the UCC Student Forum is an exercise in deliberative an... Description of other mechanisms used to consult academic staff on institutional decisions, plans, or policies: The Academic Leadership Forum in UCC is Non-executive forum for academic leadership of ... Narrative and/or website URL outlining the ad hoc mechanisms used during the previous three years to consult local community members on institutional decisions, plans, or policies: UCC supports and actively engages with the local Magazine Road Residents Association, e... Does the institution have one or more ongoing bodies through which local community-based organizations not affiliated with the institution can democratically participate in its governance?: Yes	GRI 2-29 also asks how stakeholders are identified and how the organization ensures the engagement is meaningful. STARS asks about four fixed constituencies and does not cover suppliers, customers or vulnerable groups. See the caveat on the student-consultation row.
2-30 Collective bargaining agreements	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 3: Material Topics 2021

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
3-1 Process to determine material topics	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	This is a structural difference, not missing data. AASHE determined materiality for the whole higher-education sector when it designed the STARS credit set; the institution answers that fixed set rather than identifying its own impacts. PA-2 records a climate-vulnerability assessment and PA-3 records stakeholder consultation, but neither is a materiality process and neither should be presented as one.
3-2 List of material topics	Partially reported	Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address campus operations?: Yes Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address teaching, learning, and/or research?: Yes Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address racial equity and/or social justice?: Yes Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address administration and/or finance?: Yes Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address campus and/or community engagement?: Yes	NOT A MATERIALITY DETERMINATION. These five areas are fixed by STARS and identical for every institution, so they say where an institution has set objectives, not which impacts it judged significant and why. GRI 3-2-b also requires changes against the previous reporting period, which a single STARS submission cannot show. Presenting these as material topics would overstate what the institution actually did. See the campus-operations row: fixed areas, not a materiality determination.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
3-3 Management of material topics	Partially reported	Narrative listing the institution's measurable sustainability objectives that address campus operations: Within the University's Sustainability and Climate Action Plan 2023-28, UCC has committ... Narrative outlining the activities and substantive accomplishments of the institution-wide coordinating body or officer during the previous three years: The Head of Sustainability and Climate Action coordinates the Office of Sustainability ... Has the institution made a public commitment to sustainability, as evidenced by an external commitment or a published plan?: Yes	Asked per material topic, and no material-topics list exists (see GRI 3-2) — so these are institution-wide answers to a question GRI asks topic by topic. GRI 3-3 also requires the impacts themselves (3-3-a), whether the organisation is involved through its own activities or its business relationships (3-3-b), and lessons learned (3-3-e-iv). STARS collects none of those. It reports outcomes rather than distinguishing actions that prevent potential harm from actions that remediate actual harm, which is the split GRI 3-3-d asks for.

GRI 202: Market Presence 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
202-1 Ratios of standard entry level wage by gender compared to local minimum wage	Partially reported	Percentage of employees that receive remuneration equivalent to at least a living wage: 100 Living wage: 15.40 Wage floor for regular/permanent employees: 16.40	DOES NOT SATISFY GRI 202-1. GRI wants the RATIO of standard entry-level wage to the local MINIMUM wage, BY GENDER. STARS benchmarks against a LIVING wage instead and has no gender split. Precisely: the NUMERATOR exists — PA-13's Wage floor for regular/permanent employees is the entry-level wage — but the local statutory minimum wage is not in STARS at any credit, and the gender split is not collected anywhere. Report only as a higher-education sector variant, stating plainly that 202-1 is unsatisfied. Values are bare numbers with no currency - EUR for the Irish universities, USD for Berkeley - and are not comparable across them without saying so. The DENOMINATOR is what is missing, not the numerator. STARS benchmarks against a LIVING wage, not the local statutory MINIMUM wage, and carries no minimum-wage figure at all. Supplying one would mean introducing an external constant, which is outside this project's verified-data pipeline. GRI also requires the ratio BY GENDER, which STARS does not collect at any credit — that half is unanswerable, not merely unsupplied. STARS additionally reports separate floors for short-term/casual academic and non-academic staff. Values are bare numbers: EUR for the Irish universities, USD for Berkeley, and not comparable without saying so.
202-2 Proportion of senior management hired from the local community	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	No STARS credit collects this.

GRI 204: Procurement Practices 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
204-1 Proportion of spending on local suppliers	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 301: Materials 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
301-1 Materials used by weight or volume	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	This is a sector-fit finding of the same kind as AC-1 and EN-1 on the STARS side: the framework and the institution type do not line up.
301-2 Recycled input materials used	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
301-3 Reclaimed products and their packaging materials	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 302: Energy 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
302-1 Energy consumption within the organization	Reported	Total annual energy consumption: 55,148.70 Megawatt-hours Total electricity consumption: 32,599.70 Megawatt-hours Total stationary fuel consumption: 22,549 Megawatt-hours Annual renewable energy consumption: 0.70 Megawatt-hours Renewable stationary fuels: 0 Megawatt-hours Total heating and cooling from off-site sources: 0 Megawatt-hours On-site renewable electricity exported: 0 Megawatt-hours Natural gas: 22,549 Megawatt-hours Heating oil: 0 Megawatt-hours Coal/coke: 0 Megawatt-hours Propane/LPG: 0 Megawatt-hours	GRI 302-1 expects joules or multiples and requires fuel consumption split into renewable and non-renewable. STARS reports megawatt-hours - convertible, but state the conversion. SCOPE MISMATCH. GRI 302-1-b is 'Total fuel consumption from renewable sources'. This STARS field also includes renewable ELECTRICITY (Berkeley 18,173 MWh), so it is broader than GRI's line and would overstate renewable fuel. The precise match is 'Renewable stationary fuels' - see the row below, which is ~0 for all three. Use this field only for a general renewables statement, never for GRI 302-1-b. Correct but near-empty: 0.21 MWh for TU Dublin, 0 for Cork and Berkeley. A finding in itself - these universities' renewable energy is almost entirely purchased electricity, not renewable fuel. GRI 302-1-b is therefore honestly reportable as ~zero. GRI 302-1 requires joules; STARS reports MMBtu or MWh, so the value must be converted before it is cited as a GRI figure. Zero for all three institutions in the current reporting year, so the mapping is correct but currently carries no signal. GRI 302-1 expects joules; STARS reports MWh — convertible, but state the conversion. Zero at Cork; a small residual at TU Dublin and Berkeley. Units are MWh, not joules. A reported zero, not missing data. STARS also carries an Other stationary fuels catch-all, also zero everywhere, which is what makes this list of fuel types complete rather than merely partial.
302-2 Energy consumption outside of the organization	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
302-3 Energy intensity	Reported	Annual energy consumption per person: 2,139.20 Kilowatt-hours Annual energy consumption per unit of floor area: 195.31 Kilowatt-hours per square meter	Denominator (FTE students + employees) must be disclosed with the ratio. Denominator is gross floor area; must be disclosed with the ratio.
302-4 Reduction of energy consumption	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
302-5 Reductions in energy requirements of products and services	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 303: Water and Effluents 2018

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
303-1 Interactions with water as a shared resource	Reported	Level of physical water quantity risk for the institution's main campus: Low-medium Does the institution harvest rainwater on-site for storage and use?: Yes	A risk grade is not the description GRI 303-1 asks for: it says nothing about how water is withdrawn, consumed or discharged, how the impacts were identified, or how the institution works with stakeholders on shared water resources. It also covers the main campus only, where a multi-campus institution has several. Only one of the three institutions quantifies the volume harvested; the other two answer the yes/no only.
303-2 Management of water discharge-related impacts	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
303-3 Water withdrawal	Reported	Total water withdrawal: 54,153 Cubic meters Potable water from off-site sources: 54,153 Cubic meters Potable water from on-site sources: 0 Cubic meters	GRI 303-3 requires a breakdown by source AND a separate figure for areas with water stress. STARS collects neither, so 303-3 cannot be fully satisfied from STARS alone. UNITS: GRI 303-3 requires megaliters and STARS reports cubic meters. Divide by 1,000 before citing the figure as a GRI 303-3 value, and state the conversion — the same treatment GRI 302-1 gets for megawatt-hours against joules. Maps to the specific GRI 303-3-a-v category 'Third-party water'. It is the ONLY withdrawal source these universities have — on-site abstraction is zero for all three — so this equals the total. Zero for all three institutions, which is itself the finding: none of them abstracts its own water. Retained so the GRI 303-3 source breakdown is complete rather than silent.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
303-4 Water discharge	Not reported	Assessed: the nearest STARS field (OP-3 / Annual volume of water recovered and/or returned) was reviewed and rejected as an answer to this disclosure.	GRI 303-4 requires discharge by destination, freshwater/other water split, and treatment level. STARS captures none of that. Weak mapping - verify before use.
303-5 Water consumption	Not reported	Assessed: the nearest STARS field (OP-3 / Annual potable water use) was reviewed and rejected as an answer to this disclosure.	DEFINITIONS DIFFER. GRI 303-5 water consumption = withdrawal minus discharge. STARS 'annual potable water use' is potable supply only and is not computed that way. Do not present this as GRI 303-5 without recomputing.

GRI 305: Emissions 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
305-1 Direct (Scope 1) GHG emissions	Reported	Annual scope 1 GHG emissions: 6,215.78 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 1 GHG emissions from stationary combustion: 5,517 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 1 GHG emissions from mobile combustion: 62.78 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 1 GHG fugitive emissions: 636 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent GHG emissions from biogenic sources: 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Baseline year for scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 2017 Baseline scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 19,460 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Narrative outlining when and why the GHG emissions baseline was adopted: This is the emissions baseline that has been set by the government of Ireland for all p... Description of the methodology or calculator used to conduct the scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions inventory: Calculated by our contracted supplier Sustineo to GHG Protocol standards and ISO 14064-...	GRI 305-1 additionally requires biogenic CO2 to be reported separately from the gross figure. GRI asks for biogenic CO2 specifically; the STARS field is CO2-equivalent and may not be the same boundary. STARS reports ONE baseline covering scope 1 and scope 2 together. GRI states the base year separately for 305-1 and 305-2, so this figure serves both jointly and neither alone — it cannot be split. So it answers 305-1-d-ii and 305-2-d-ii only as a combined total, which is weaker than either disclosure asks for on its own. GRI additionally requires the source of the emission factors and GWP rates (305-1-e) and the consolidation approach (305-1-f); STARS collects neither. Not populated by this institution: OP-6 / Scope 1 GHG process emissions.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
305-2 Energy indirect (Scope 2) GHG emissions	Reported	Annual scope 2 GHG emissions: 8,144 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 2 GHG emissions from off-site sources of electricity (market-based): 8,144 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 2 GHG emissions from off-site sources of electricity (location-based): 8,144 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 2 GHG emissions from off-site sources of heating and cooling: 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Baseline year for scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 2017 Baseline scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 19,460 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Narrative outlining when and why the GHG emissions baseline was adopted: This is the emissions baseline that has been set by the government of Ireland for all p... Description of the methodology or calculator used to conduct the scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions inventory: Calculated by our contracted supplier Sustineo to GHG Protocol standards and ISO 14064-...	GRI 305-2 requires location-based and, where available, market-based figures reported separately. Do not present a single scope 2 number without saying which method. STARS reports ONE baseline covering scope 1 and scope 2 together. GRI states the base year separately for 305-1 and 305-2, so this figure serves both jointly and neither alone — it cannot be split. So it answers 305-1-d-ii and 305-2-d-ii only as a combined total, which is weaker than either disclosure asks for on its own. GRI additionally requires the source of the emission factors and GWP rates (305-2-e) and the consolidation approach (305-2-f); STARS collects neither.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
305-3 Other indirect (Scope 3) GHG emissions	Reported	Scope 3 GHG emissions from business travel: 3,565 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 3 GHG emissions from commuting: 20,991 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 3 GHG emissions from purchased goods and services: 1,572 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 3 GHG emissions from capital goods: 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 3 GHG emissions from fuel- and energy-related activities not included in scope 1 or scope 2: 3,318 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent	Not populated by this institution: OP-6 / Scope 3 GHG emissions from waste generated in operations.
305-4 GHG emissions intensity	Reported	Annual scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions per person: 557.01 Kilograms of CO2 equivalent Annual scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions per unit of floor area: 50.86 Kilograms per square meter	GRI 305-4 requires the denominator to be stated. Here it is FTE students + employees, not a corporate revenue or output metric. Denominator is gross floor area in square meters; must be disclosed alongside the ratio.
305-5 Reduction of GHG emissions	Reported	Percentage reduction in scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions from baseline: 26.21 Baseline scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 19,460 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Baseline year for scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 2017 Narrative outlining when and why the GHG emissions baseline was adopted: This is the emissions baseline that has been set by the government of Ireland for all p...	GRI 305-5 asks for reductions as an ABSOLUTE quantity in metric tons CO2e; STARS gives a percentage. Not directly substitutable - derive the absolute figure from the baseline and current fields. Derive it; do not present the baseline itself as a reduction. The subtraction is only valid because both figures cover the same combined scope 1 + 2 boundary. STARS reports ONE baseline covering scope 1 and scope 2 together. GRI states the base year separately for 305-1 and 305-2, so this figure serves both jointly and neither alone — it cannot be split. GRI 305-5-b (gases included) and 305-5-d (which scopes the reductions occurred in) remain unanswered — STARS reports the reduction against the combined scope 1 + 2 total without attributing it to either.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
305-6 Emissions of ozone-depleting substances (ODS)	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS 3.0 collects no ODS data at any credit. Cannot be reported from this dataset.
305-7 Nitrogen oxides (NOx), sulfur oxides (SOx), and other significant air emissions	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS 3.0 collects no criteria-air-pollutant data. Cannot be reported from this dataset.

GRI 306: Waste 2020

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
306-1 Waste generation and significant waste-related impacts	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
306-2 Management of significant waste-related impacts	Reported	Does the institution have a surplus program through which institution-owned items that are no longer needed are stored for eventual sale, donation, or reuse?: Yes Does the institution have or participate in a reuse program through which employees and/or students can donate personal items for redistribution?: Yes Has the institution eliminated the on-site use of at least one form of single-use disposable plastic?: Yes Does the institution have a hazardous waste management program or protocol that includes measures to minimize or reduce the use of hazardous materials?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's composting program: Compostable lunchboxes are accepted in the University's food waste bins. Does the institution have sufficient data on construction and demolition waste to pursue this indicator?: Yes	GRI 306-3 additionally requires hazardous waste to be quantified separately from non-hazardous. STARS quantifies only non-hazardous and construction-and-demolition waste, so the tonnage is unavailable. It states data sufficiency as a yes/no rather than describing the collection process, and covers construction and demolition waste only.
306-3 Waste generated	Reported	Annual non-hazardous waste generated: 520 Metric tons Annual construction and demolition waste generated: 6,914.08 Metric tons	NOT EQUIVALENT - a subset. GRI 306-3-a is TOTAL waste generated including hazardous, broken down by composition. STARS reports non-hazardous only and collects no hazardous tonnage at any credit, so 306-3 cannot be fully satisfied. Do not present non-hazardous waste as the organisation's total waste. (Contrast the 306-4 and 306-5 rows, which are component : GRI has explicit non-hazardous lines at 306-4-c and 306-5-c for the STARS figures to answer, whereas 306-3 has no non-hazardous sub-requirement at all — which is why this row is weaker than those two, not equal to them.)

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
306-4 Waste diverted from disposal	Reported	Total non-hazardous waste diverted from disposal: 242 Metric tons Non-hazardous waste recycled: 183 Metric tons Non-hazardous waste composted: 59 Metric tons Non-hazardous waste prepared for reuse: 0 Metric tons Total construction and demolition waste diverted from disposal: 6,837.95 Metric tons Construction and demolition waste recycled: 5,675.22 Metric tons	Exact scope match on GRI 306-4-c, including its split by recovery operation (reuse / recycling / other) from the rows below. GRI 306-4-d additionally wants each operation split on-site vs off-site, which STARS does not collect. NOT THE WHOLE DISCLOSURE: the hazardous half is absent. STARS weighs no hazardous waste anywhere — OP-11 records only whether a hazardous-waste programme exists and describes it in prose. For a research university that is a materially significant stream going unreported, and it is a finding about STARS rather than about these institutions.
306-5 Waste directed to disposal	Reported	Non-hazardous waste disposed of to a landfill or incinerator: 278 Metric tons Construction and demolition waste disposed of to a landfill or incinerator: 76.13 Metric tons	WEAKER THAN THE 306-4 EQUIVALENT: GRI 306-5-c also requires the total split across four disposal operations — incineration with energy recovery, incineration without, landfilling, other — and STARS merges landfill and incineration into a single figure. The waste-to-energy percentage field would separate incineration with recovery, but only two of the three institutions report it, so the split cannot be derived consistently. NOT THE WHOLE DISCLOSURE: the hazardous half is absent. STARS weighs no hazardous waste anywhere — OP-11 records only whether a hazardous-waste programme exists and describes it in prose. For a research university that is a materially significant stream going unreported, and it is a finding about STARS rather than about these institutions.

GRI 308: Supplier Environmental Assessment 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
308-1 New suppliers that were screened using environmental criteria	Partially reported	Does the institution's supplier code of conduct include one or more expectations in regard to environmental impact that exceed or are additional to regulatory compliance?: No Percentage of bid solicitations that identify supplier sustainability considerations: 21	GRI 308-1 requires a percentage of new suppliers actually screened. STARS reports the existence of the criteria, not their application to any supplier, so no percentage can be derived. The denominator is bid solicitations, not new suppliers, and one solicitation may attract many suppliers or none. 'Sustainability considerations' is also broader than the environmental criteria GRI 308-1 specifies. The figure is 0 percent at TU Dublin, so a low value here should not be read as a screening failure without checking the product-specification field alongside it.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
308-2 Negative environmental impacts in the supply chain and actions taken	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 401: Employment 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
401-1 New employee hires and employee turnover	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS 3.0 collects no hiring or turnover figures.
401-2 Benefits provided to full-time employees that are not provided to temporary or part-time employees	Partially reported	Percentage of employees eligible for paid all-gender family/medical leave: 100	GRI 401-2 turns on the contrast between full-time employees and temporary or part-time employees, and asks for the benefits by significant location of operation. STARS gives a single institution-wide eligibility rate with no employment-type split, so the comparison the disclosure exists to make cannot be drawn.
401-3 Parental leave	Partially reported	Number of weeks of paid maternity leave: 26 Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the maternity leave options available to employees: Under the maternity legislation all women are entitled to 42 weeks maternity leave. Pay...	GRI 401-3 requires headcounts by gender: employees entitled to parental leave, those who took it, those who returned, those still employed twelve months later, and the resulting return-to-work and retention rates. STARS reports none of these — it reports the policy, not its uptake. 'Maternity' is also narrower than GRI's 'parental'. Descriptive only; supplies none of the headcounts or rates GRI 401-3 requires.

GRI 403: Occupational Health and Safety 2018

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
403-1 Occupational health and safety management system	Partially reported	Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's workplace health and safety committees: The University has a Safety Representative Forum. The aim of the Forum is to enhance th...	STARS never asks the 403-1 question, so an answer only appears where the institution volunteered it. Nothing records whether the system exists because of a legal requirement, which standard it follows, or which workers, activities and workplaces it covers — that is 403-1-b, and it is absent.
403-2 Hazard identification, risk assessment, and incident investigation	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
403-3 Occupational health services	Partially reported	Does the institution make physical health services available to employees?: Yes	General employee health services are not occupational health services: GRI 403-3 is about the function that identifies and eliminates workplace hazards, and about how worker health data is kept confidential. STARS asks about neither.
403-4 Worker participation, consultation, and communication on occupational health and safety	Reported	Does the institution have an institution-wide health and safety committee or network of committees that brings together workers and management in the development and review of workplace health and safety policies and procedures?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's workplace health and safety committees: The University has a Safety Representative Forum. The aim of the Forum is to enhance th...	GRI 403-4-b further requires the committee's responsibilities, meeting frequency, decision-making authority, and whether any workers are unrepresented. STARS records existence only. Depth varies by institution; meeting frequency and decision-making authority are not consistently stated.
403-5 Worker training on occupational health and safety	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
403-6 Promotion of worker health	Reported	Does the institution make physical health services available to employees?: Yes Does the institution make behavioral health services available to employees?: Yes Does the institution make free or reduced cost fitness activities available to employees?: Yes Does the institution prohibit smoking and tobacco use across the entire campus?: No Does the institution make contemplative and/or spiritual activities available to employees?: Yes	GRI 403-6-a also requires the scope of access provided; STARS records availability as a yes/no, with the scope left to the narrative. A prohibition is a control rather than a voluntary promotion service; STARS also records the weaker variants (indoor-only, restricted outdoor smoking) in separate fields.
403-7 Prevention and mitigation of occupational health and safety impacts directly linked by business relationships	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
403-8 Workers covered by an occupational health and safety management system	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
403-9 Work-related injuries	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	PA-11 (Health, Safety and Wellbeing) contains no injury figures - its only numeric fields are STARS scoring artefacts. Cannot be reported.
403-10 Work-related ill health	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	PA-11 contains no ill-health figures. Cannot be reported.

GRI 405: Diversity and Equal Opportunity 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
405-1 Diversity of governance bodies and employees	Reported	Ethnic diversity index for executive staff: 0 Percentage of executive staff that identify as women or other marginalized gender identities: 47 Percentage of regular/permanent academic staff that identify as women or other marginalized gender identities: 49 Percentage of regular/permanent non-academic staff that identify as women or other marginalized gender identities: 63 Ethnic diversity index for academic staff: 0.44 Ethnic diversity index for non-academic staff: 0.34	This is a diversity INDEX (a single 0-1 concentration score), not the percentage breakdown GRI 405-1-b asks for. It shows how mixed the group is, not what share each group holds. No STARS credit collects employee age at all, so GRI 405-1's age-group split (under 30 / 30-50 / over 50) is unanswerable for every employee category. 405-1-a is still not answered: STARS PA-3 records which constituencies are represented on the highest decision-making body, never what percentage of that body they make up. DATA QUALITY: TU Dublin's value is the string '0 Revised on Nov. 24, 2025' — annotation text concatenated onto the figure — so the field is typed <code>text</code>, not <code>number</code>, and will not parse. Cork and Berkeley are clean. STARS reports one combined figure for 'women or other marginalized gender identities' rather than a percentage per gender, so the split GRI asks for is two buckets, not three.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
405-2 Ratio of basic salary and remuneration of women to men	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS FIELDS: nothing. PA-13 covers living-wage coverage and wage floors, not a gender pay ratio — despite the credit being named 'Pay Equity'. BUT the evidence documents linked from STARS answers partially close this: UCC publishes V3EDIGenderPayGapReport2025.pdf and TU Dublin Gender-Pay-Gap-Report-2023-FINALv1.pdf, both stating a mean gender pay gap. Berkeley links no equivalent. NOT a substitute for 405-2: GRI wants the ratio of basic salary and remuneration of women to men PER EMPLOYEE CATEGORY and per significant location; these reports give one organisation-wide percentage. Reportable as context with the source named, for 2 of 3 institutions, and it must be read out of the PDF by a human — it is not in any structured field, so it cannot go through the Jinja2 number path.

Verifying this report

Every figure above is recorded in `report/output/index_provenance.csv` with the exact STARS credit and field it came from, so any number can be traced to a row of the source dataset without trusting the generator. `tests/test_content_index.py` re-derives them independently of the code that produced them.